

Laika, written by Valentino Nioi
– edited portfolio excerpt –

EXT. ALIEN PLANET – LAVA LAKE

The hill is a massive crater harboring a luminous lake of golden lava. The WOMAN and BRO – her vocal AI – stand at the edge. Storm winds howl around them.

WOMAN

It's amazing. Have you ever seen anything like this?

BRO

Negative. This environment is uni-

A dissonant alien melody cuts in. Her display glitches. Bro's voice turns to noise.

WOMAN

Bro?

Tiny particles – her body, the ground, the lava – all defy gravity, ascending into the sky. From the lake: a strange lava slime slowly emerges, reaching toward her.

In a second, she runs away back to her ship.

WOMAN (CONT'D)

Bro – set the map back to the ship.

BRO

(confused)

O...kay...

Display: 239°C.

EXT. PLANET – NEAR THE SPACESHIP

290°C... 301°C... Lightning strikes. Golden light bursts from the cracking ground.

WOMAN

(screaming)

OPEN THE DOOR AND GET READY FOR
TAKEOFF.

Bro opens the hatch remotely. She sprints, seals it, collapses. Looking back at the soil — her footprints look like those of a dog.

An earthquake.

Black.

EXT. ALIEN PLANET - MOMENTS LATER

The woman wakes floating on the sky above the surface, body arranged like The Hanged Man Tarot card. The lava slime towers beneath her, almost within reach. She drifts slowly down, eyes resigned.

WOMAN

Bro... Now, what do we do?

Only glitches coming from BRO system. Then a voice — same timbre as hers — crumbly through a static noise.

VOICE

Seemed like... it... is... waiting
for... something.

WOMAN

Could you save me?

VOICE

Yes.

WOMAN

Please do it.

VOICE

No. Intended to end this way.

WOMAN

What's the melody?

VOICE

My voice.

The slime forms a human half-bust, arm reaching out. A blinding flash — then, through the glitch, Bro returns.

BRO

Space traveler...

WOMAN

I thought we weren't allowed to
talk again.

BRO

Why did you choose to land here?

WOMAN

Because the planet was beautiful.
And it seemed to wait for
something.

BRO

That was your purpose.

WOMAN

That was ours. Goodbye, Bro...

BRO

Until we'll meet again.

A huge explosion. The planet disappears. Darkness — except
for the far stars. Floating in the abyss: human corpses,
animal bodies, lifeless trees.

ON SCREEN:

"In this burial grave, beneath the
celestial space, in rest our body
stays, and your soul forever
remembered, reaches for the stars."

END OF EXCERPT